Fire & Water
A love story

by
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EXT. DAWN, FOREST

The first morning light is gray. Cold air starts to warm as the sun creeps to barely peak over the horizon. The tiniest water droplets start to form on a leaf high in a tree. Two tiny droplets and then a third join together. The droplet, SALLY, has a smile on her face. Looking through watery eyes of the droplet that slowly grows, the colors of the forest become less gray and slightly more vivid and we see the edge of the sun as it breaks the black horizon.

NEARBY

A dying campfire’s burning embers feel the first ray of sunlight and it cracks. A spark flies in slow motion in a large arch. The spark is alive, HE is so excited. He looks right at Sally, and he, Jerry, is very alive and energetic, trying to impress her.

Sally sees him, the spark Jerry, and she is in awe.

Jerry looks to where he is going, a dried reed, and determination sets in as he gathers speed and braces for impact. He hits, and then there is silence. Then a smolder and a wisp of smoke. Suddenly a small flame. Jerry is victorious! He looks up to see her reaction, is she impressed?

Such energy and charisma! It’s contagious, she gasps and in excitement gathers weight and bends the leaf she is on to drop near him. She sees that she will drop right next to him and determination and satisfaction spread across her face. She lands in a light splatter.

There is a hiss. She has hit the side of him! She almost put him out! He looks at her in fear and wonderment. He instinctively moves away. As he reflexively moves back he overtakes the whole bush and quadruples in size unexpectedly.

She is horrified at the effect she has created and now overwhelmed at his giant size. She tries to slink away. There is a very small puddle gathered in the imprint of a boot heel. She grows into the small puddle and now bigger, she looks up at him. Ashamed but with forlorn hope.

He looks down at her and is at a loss, he hesitates and then tries to move towards her. But just then...

LIGHTNING, THUNDER FLASH

EXT. DAY, FOREST

Lightning strikes a tree, breaking a branch off. The large branch falls and it catches fire, much bigger than Jerry. Tom is the fire demon, serious and all powerful! Rain is falling but doesn’t affect Tom as he grows to a nearby tree. He looks to our Jerry and beckons to join him. Jerry is torn, but decides to ignore Tom and tries to approach Sally again. As Jerry does, rain gets in the way and his movements are thwarted.

She follows him with her gaze longingly not sure what to do. Every time Jerry tries to make a move toward her, he gets hit by a raindrop or is stopped by growing puddles. Water is collecting everywhere and starting to become predominant, pooling and starting to flow. She gets swept away, almost against her will but she doesn't resist. She understands that waiting for him is fruitless and even dangerous to him. The flow is natural and moving seems correct. Suddenly, almost surprisingly, she starts to cry, her tears joining the rest of the water.

He watches her start to get further away.

He looks over at Tom. Tom is devouring a small tree. He looks over at Jerry and beckons him. A beam of sunlight piercing the rain clouds invites him as well. Jerry gazes up following the beam of

light and looks at the clouds that threaten his existence.

Wind, WILLOW, parts the clouds and playfully flies down where SALLY is. Willow blows on her cheek and she looks up, expecting Jerry.
She is disappointed. Jerry is in the background looking for a path to travel but is trapped.

Willow sees that she is looking at Jerry and is confused. Sally looks away sadly and starts to join the rest of the water.

A shade passes overhead. Sally looks up at a cloud. Like looking up at your mother.

Sally is worried the whole forest may catch on fire.

Jerry tries to jump to her but Tom gets in the way.

Jerry ends up jumping into Tom and surrendering himself. There is a silent battle as the two struggle within. Tom, after some struggle, comes out victorious.

CUT BACK

Sally sees this and gets very upset. She hates Tom who consumed her Jerry and now looks to consume her forest. She stops caring about herself. She sets her eyes on Tom and gathers herself to charge him. She pulls herself in and shoots out like a stream at him.

Tom looks back at where she is hitting him with a small and pitiful stream. She is still so small that she has little effect on him. Tom is slightly shocked for a moment. Part of him gets put out, but he realizes that her attempt is pitiful and chuckles. She is furious but she is almost powerless. She tries to draw herself together into a stream again but her second attempt is even more pitiful and he just laughs not even pausing as he continues moving away from her.

As Tom moves away from her she can see through him, just a bit better in the small area that she did effect and what she couldn’t see before is visible for a moment. The small forlorn, almost prisoner, Jerry, who tried to overcome Tom. Jerry looks at her for help as he is carried away by Tom and then the moment is gone and she can’t see him.

A low rumble starts building, very slowly.

One tree catches on fire and then a second. She watches. It is still raining and she is slowly, so very slowly, growing into a puddle again. Tom is growing by leaps and bounds. He goes for a third tree but something pulls him back, Jerry has snagged on a rock and is holding on for dear life to halt Tom. It is a pitiful attempt. He is yanked as soon as Tom figures it out and a 3rd tree is taken over.

A low rumble has been building and now we finally see why. Water has been collecting and is now gushing, it rushes to meet Sally and she is finally vindicated. She surges and becomes torrential. She comes down on Tom with fury. Jerry sees her and is horrified. She notices him but is too far committed to change. Tom is extinguished.

She is spent with the effort and the sky clears. She is just a puddle again and all that is left of Jerry is a small lump of coal. She rushes as best she can, small, but over wet ground and brings him a twig. Nothing happens. She rushes around to find more and brings him another and another, nothing happens. She starts to give up but Willow comes by. A tiny dried leaf on the

edge of a twig finally catches as Willow blows on it.

At first there is a flame with no face and then after many seconds, an eye. Then the whole face of Jerry. He looks at her amazed and happy barely believing. He starts to move toward her but halts realizing they can’t coexist. Then he boldly moves forward towards her.

She is shocked, afraid of what will happen. He smiles at her as a bit of steam rises. They both watch the movement of it rising up and she starts to giggle.

We then see all the twigs and leaves behind him, that she collected. He spreads to them so as to be in front of her. Her eyes are closed but he smiles at her once he is in front. She peeks at him and turns away again. He notices a leaf falling just above her and shoots out to grab it before it dirties the water. She peeks at him slightly impressed.

There is a small pile of burnt sticks and coal near him. He grabs one behind his back so as not to show her and laughs a bit with her as he supplies himself with the coal. She notices

anyway and grabs another twig and gives it to him.

Boldly he moves a little closer, She is hesitant, a bit afraid of the result, but soon her cheeks become flushed and she likes the sensation of his heat. She is flushed and this makes him more bold coming even closer.

He creates a half ring around her as if embracing her and eating the twigs that she had previously pushed to her edge. She is more and more flushed, becoming slightly delirious with his heat and the feeling of it. She starts to bubble slightly, they are both surprised but they love it.

Steam floats up and we follow it until it collects on a broad leaf above them creating tiny droplets that quickly form faces and smile, as their mother once did, and they dance about with high pitched glee.

THE END